NATALIIA NIKOLSKA

Staff-level Backend Engineer | Java | Fintech & Commerce
Remote B2B contractor | US/EU business hours

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 14+ years in Java, building and modernizing business-critical, event-driven systems in fintech, commerce, and telecom. I take on the riskiest parts of a platform - monolith decomposition, data consistency across parallel systems, and unstable production - and make them predictable. I work end to end: from discovery and requirements with the business to architecture, delivery, and technical leadership.

- **Fintech:** stabilized a consumer-credit platform - incidents from 4-5/day to 2-3/month; release frequency increased from 1-2 to 3-4 times per week.
- **Modernization:** designed Kafka-based bidirectional synchronization for a major US pharmaceutical distributor, keeping inventory, lot, and order-reservation data consistent while legacy and new services operated in parallel.
- **Performance:** redesigned a legacy flow from ~4 hours to 2 minutes (120x).

Remote B2B contractor, available across US/EU business hours.

SKILLS

System Design & Architecture: microservices, legacy modernization, monolith decomposition, event-driven architecture, domain boundaries, distributed data synchronization, batch processing, technical discovery, requirements clarification, architecture and design reviews, delivery-risk management, API design

Engineering Leadership: mentoring

Backend Engineering: Java, Python, Spring Framework, Spring Boot, Spring Data, Spring Batch

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, AI-assisted development, agentic workflows, spec-driven development, task automation

APIs & Integrations: REST APIs, OpenAPI, SOAP, MS Teams Telephony, OpenSIPS, gRPC

Data Storage: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, Cosmos DB, Hibernate, Liquibase

Messaging: Apache Kafka, Azure Service Bus, RabbitMQ

Cloud & Platform: AWS, Azure

DevOps: Docker, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Testcontainers, Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform

Testing: JUnit, unit testing, integration testing, end-to-end testing, test data isolation, automated regression testing

Incident Response & Troubleshooting: production incident prevention

Observability & Operations: logging design, log retention, production troubleshooting, incident recovery, safe rollout practices

EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer | Axeos, Netherlands | Part-time Contractor May 2026 - Present
Telecom integration platform.

- Delivered and productionized an end-to-end Microsoft Teams Telephony workflow, rebuilding inherited implementation where needed and launching a capability for approximately 50 resellers.
- Reduced regression time by 27% through automated CI/CD checks; increased test coverage from 0% to 81% and documented expected behaviour for nine critical service flows.
- Established quality guardrails for AI-assisted development and doubled development speed on an owned service through automated tests, a Claude Code workflow, and team knowledge-sharing.

- Introduced version-controlled Liquibase migrations and Docker-based local development, replacing implicit schema updates with controlled, reviewable database changes.

Senior Backend Engineer | Monobank (Universal Bank), Ukraine June 2025 - April 2026
Consumer-credit platform for installment payments and pay-later financing.

- Reduced production incidents from 4-5 per day to 2-3 per month through platform stabilization, observability, and technical-debt prioritization; saved an estimated 24-27 engineering hours weekly.
- Reduced test flakiness from ~40% to ~1% and suite runtime from 20 to 5-6 minutes, saving about eight engineer hours per feature.
- Co-designed and implemented separation of store-domain models from the credit domain, enabling independent store-only releases and increasing release frequency from 1-2 to 3-4 times weekly.
- Reduced a monthly report query from over five minutes to 20-30 seconds, avoiding production-impacting database blocking.
- Introduced a transactional outbox for Kafka debt updates, making messages persisted and traceable across database commits and published events.

Senior Backend Engineer | EPAM, Ukraine August 2024 - May 2025
Modernization programme for a major US pharmaceutical distributor.

- Translated undocumented legacy behaviour into validated requirements and production-ready Java microservices during phased migration.
- Designed Kafka-based bidirectional synchronization of inventory, lot, and order-reservation data between legacy and new systems; used CDC, application events, and origin filtering to prevent loops while both systems operated in parallel.
- Kept delivery moving amid delayed stakeholder validation by documenting assumptions, edge cases, and test scenarios.
- Implemented required Azure infrastructure changes in Terraform when DevOps capacity was constrained, with subsequent DevOps review.

Senior Backend Engineer | Traffic Market, Ukraine June 2024 - July 2024
Early-stage affiliate-marketing MVP.

- Established the development foundation: Docker-based environment, CI/CD, database, and five core services.

Senior Backend Engineer | proteanTecs, Israel January 2022 - January 2024
Monitoring and analytics platform for advanced electronics.

- Standardized the Python SDK used by ML algorithms to retrieve data from the Java backend, improving its API and documentation.
- Increased SDK test coverage from 45% to 90% within six months through daily end-to-end smoke tests.
- Designed an algorithm plugin-management system that enabled a five-engineer MLOps team to build and deploy custom algorithms independently.

Backend Engineering Lead | EPAM, Ukraine June 2018 - December 2021
Real-estate data and workflow platform.

- Led a five-developer team through senior-team turnover without a drop in delivery quality; mentored two junior engineers to mid-level within one year.
- Contributed to IBM RPG-to-Java migration that enabled full decommissioning of the legacy AS/400 platform by 2020.

Backend Engineer | EPAM, Ukraine October 2015 - May 2018
Warehouse-management modernization programme.

- Redesigned a performance-critical flow using set-based SQL, cutting runtime from approximately four hours to two minutes (about 120x).

Java Developer | EPAM, Ukraine February 2015 - October 2015
E-commerce platform for a major Canadian retailer.

- Built Hybris e-commerce functionality: user accounts, order processing, search customization, and location-aware shopping flows.

Software Engineer | B2B Procurement Platform, Ukraine May 2012 - January 2015
Tender-based procurement and auction platform.

- Built Java/Spring backend functionality for tender-based procurement and auction workflows, including billing and ERP data exchange through SOAP.

EDUCATION & COURSES

National University of Kyiv-Mohyla Academy - Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science | 2005-2009

Developing Applications with Google Cloud Platform - Coursera | August 2019

Ultimate AWS Certified Developer Associate 2021 - Udemy | November 2021

Python Bootcamp - Udemy | 2022

Software Architecture & System Design Practical Case Studies - Udemy | May 2026